

Watch your videos on the **Apple TV**

A no-jargon guide to playing the videos from your home server (Jellyfin) on your Apple TV — using the easiest app, or the VLC you already have. Read it when you're tired; it's meant to just work.

The 30-second mental model

Two pieces talk to each other over your home Wi-Fi:

 The server (Jellyfin)	Your own private Netflix. It runs on your home cluster and holds all your videos. You don't touch it — it just sits there serving.
 The app (on Apple TV)	The "player." It connects to the server, shows your library, and plays a video on the big screen.

That's it. The app needs to know **one address** to find the server — that's the only setup.

★ The one thing to know — your server address

`http://192.168.5.173:30096`

Type it exactly, including **:30096** at the end — and **http**, not https. No certificate prompt, it just connects. Your Apple TV only needs the **same Wi-Fi**. (Another address that works: **192.168.5.96:30096**.)



The easy way: the **Swiftfin** app

RECOMMENDED

Swiftfin is a **free** app made specifically for Jellyfin on Apple TV. It's the nicest experience — posters, "continue watching," the works. This is the path to try first.

- 1 On the Apple TV, open the **App Store** and search **Swiftfin**. Install it (it's free).
- 2 Open Swiftfin. It'll ask to **add a server** — choose **Add Server / Connect Manually**.
- 3 Type your address exactly: **http://192.168.5.173:30096** (include the **:30096**, and use **http**).
- 4 No certificate warning to deal with — it's a plain, direct connection on your own network.
- 5 **Log in** with your Jellyfin username and password.
- 6 Open the **Hacker News FM** library → pick a video → press play. 🎉



Infuse is another popular Apple TV app that also works with Jellyfin — a fine alternative if you ever want to try one. But Swiftfin is free and purpose-built, so start there.

Why an "app" and not just a website?

Apple TV doesn't really do web browsers. So instead of visiting **jellyfin.lan** in a browser (which is how you'd see it on a laptop), you use an **app** that knows how to talk to Jellyfin. Same server, same videos — just a TV-friendly remote-controlled front door.

B The "I already have VLC" way

You've got **VLC** on your Apple TV and like it — great. VLC isn't a Jellyfin app, but it can still **find your server over the network** using something called **DLNA** (think: a way for media gadgets on the same Wi-Fi to discover and share with each other). One small one-time switch in Jellyfin, then VLC can browse it.

One-time: turn on DLNA in Jellyfin (from a laptop)

- 1 On a computer, go to **<https://jellyfin.lan>** and sign in.
- 2 Go to **Dashboard** → **Plugins** (or **Playback** on older versions) and enable/install **DLNA**. Save.

(If you can't find DLNA, don't sweat it — just use Swiftfin from Way A. DLNA is the only reason VLC needs this step.)

On the Apple TV, in VLC

- 1 Open **VLC**.
- 2 Go to the **Network** tab → **Local Network**.
- 3 Your **Jellyfin** server should appear in the list (that's DLNA working). Open it.
- 4 Browse into your videos and press play.

💡 Honest note: VLC will play the files, but it won't show the nice posters, descriptions, or "resume where you left off." For your AI videos with their cover art and metadata, **Swiftfin (Way A) looks much better**. Keep VLC as a handy backup.

? If it won't connect (quick fixes)

Server not found	Make sure the Apple TV is on the same Wi-Fi as the cluster. This is the #1 cause.
Server not found	Type http://192.168.5.173:30096 exactly — the :30096 matters. Try the other node IP 192.168.5.96:30096 .
It demands "https"	Use http for this address, not https — it's a direct LAN connection, no certificate involved. (Note: jellyfin.lan only resolves on the Mac, so don't use that name on the Apple TV.)
Wrong password	Use your Jellyfin account (the one you log into at jellyfin.lan), not your Apple ID.
New videos missing	They appear automatically, but you can force it: on a laptop at jellyfin.lan → Dashboard → Scan All Libraries.

📖 Tiny glossary

Media server	The computer program that stores your videos and serves them on demand. Yours is Jellyfin .
Client / app	The thing you watch <i>with</i> — Swiftfin or VLC on the Apple TV.
Library	A collection inside Jellyfin. Yours is " Hacker News FM ."
IP address	A device's number on your network, like a house address. Your server's is 192.168.5.173 .
LAN / Wi-Fi	Your home network. Everything here only works when devices share it.
DLNA	An older "discover media on the network" standard. It's how VLC finds Jellyfin.

✓ **Your server has a plain, number-only address: `http://192.168.5.173:30096` — no name, no certificate, no fuss. That's the one to type on the Apple TV.**

You've got this. Same Wi-Fi → install Swiftfin → type **`http://192.168.5.173:30096`** → log in → play. 💜